



Skating style New synthetic fibres developed during the decade allowed for practical, comfortable sportswear. This young figure-skater's outfit follows the fashionable silhouette, while giving greater ease of movement.



Swing time Golf attire offered smart but casual fashions for women, both as sportswear and leisurewear. However, this golfer of the 1950s would not have been allowed to wear such brief shorts while she was on the green.



Glamorous pursuit Fencing, with its skilful, balletic moves and dashing, trouser-wearing women, has long inspired fashion and sportswear designers. Here, Bress Aboularia models her practice wear for the French women's fencing team in the 1950s.



Courtside style Tennis was both a social and sporting occasion. Crisp, white, belted tunics and full skirts created a feminine impression on the court, especially when paired with a fitted, cropped cardigan – as worn here by American world no.1 Shirley June Fry Irvine (right).

CHEERLEADING GLAMOUR



Cheerleading is an American phenomenon that began in the late 1800s as an activity for boys, but by the 1950s had become dominated by girls. In an era that prized athleticism, cheerleading provided an outlet for girls, who had limited choices when it came to school and college sports. The uniforms were considered the height of teen glamour – knee-length skirts (that had crept shorter by the 1960s), letter sweaters, bobby sox with saddle shoes, and the all-important pom poms, originally made of crepe paper and then of water-resistant vinyl in the mid-1960s.